

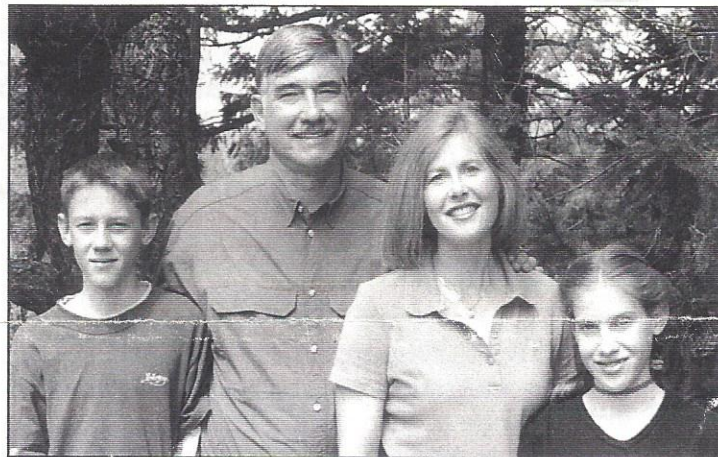


Saracoff Sentinel 2003 Thank-Christ-a-New Edition*



A Good Time to Give Thanks

God is faithful, good and He is in control! His promises are meant to be claimed. *"They shall run and not grow weary..."* Anna just won an apple pie in her school's annual Turkey Trot Race. *"I will rescue you..."* Ian had surgery on his left middle finger after cutting the tendon while trying to slice a banana with a butcher knife. *"You will honor me."* Both kids are doing great on their grades. Kathy, in addition to all her other duties, is helping Moms in Touch with their Spanish ministry. I just attended a men's retreat and saw how God ministered to me through many brothers in Christ. A blessing from our family to yours during this season.



A picture of the Saracoffs taken at Kathy's family reunion in Colorado commemorating the 50th wedding anniversary of her missionary parents, Frank and Sally Dennis.

The Saracoffs:

Dee Kathy Ian Anna.

The Transition to LAM

God is teaching us to walk in faith these days. While Kathy and I feel a new vigor being back with LAM, change is scary and the enemy is prowling. Your prayers and concern for us during these transitioning times for us have meant more than we can say. Since changing missions, we have been asked many questions. The following are some of them, plus a few we thought you might be wondering:

Are you going to move? Will you be working with different people?

Have your goals changed? What will happen to short term teams?

Lord willing, we plan to stay here and serve the people of Tijuana. As for the ministries, we will continue to help the elderly home, the drug rehabilitation center, and children. Our ministry to orphanages and children's work will be changing somewhat. Emmanuel Orphanages are developing their own path (see other side). Our goals have been and are:

1. to involve U.S. churches and individuals in the work of helping the people of Tijuana through our letters, the one day trips, and short term teams.
2. to encourage Latin leaders in the Lord through prayer, fellowship & leadership conferences.
3. to network with the ministry leaders so they can help each other.
4. to meet the needs of the poor: mothers, children, drug addicts and the elderly.
5. to be more like Christ as we serve.



*Thank Christ a New!

Thanksgiving, Christmas and New Year in honor of a beloved Taiwan missionary, "Uncle Ham," who started this tradition and my parents who continue it.

"Thanks be to God for His indescribable gift!" 2 Corinthians 9:15



Short Term Team Eye Clinic

This year has been filled with great teams from all over the country, and many projects have been completed due to all their help. During Veteran's Day weekend, a team of eye doctors from Sacramento came to Tijuana, some of them for the 10th year! They always bring so much hope for people in Tijuana. Two clinics were held, with hundreds of pairs of glasses given away.

One clinic was held at the Old Folks Home and the other was in the neighborhood of Emperadores, where the Saracoffs first started their ministry. Many friends stopped by to have their vision checked. Also many school-aged children received glasses so they can now read the board at school and do their assignments.

We would like to give a big thanks to all those teams that have come down to share in the work in Tijuana; you have made an impact. The people will remember the love you have given and we know God will reward you!

Kathy's Corner

**SORRY FOR THE
CONFUSION!
MINISTRY
(AND MINISTERS)
ARE UNDER
CONSTRUCTION**



Our Confidence:

*"Offer to God
a sacrifice of thanksgiving,
and pay your vows to the Most High;
And call upon me in the day of trouble;
I shall rescue you,
And you will honor me."
Psalm 50:14-15*

Emmanuel Orphanage Goes on its Own

We are pleased to see that Emmanuel Orphanage, under the leadership of Eduardo Mendez, has decided to become more independent of us, putting out their own newsletter and also searching out support on their own. We love them; we did not abandon them, but they have—on their own—wanted to move in a direction allowing them more autonomy. We think this is a good thing. While it does cause some confusion, especially for all of you supporters, it is a step of growth for them. Please be patient; we're praying for you.

In part, our resignation from CFCI and current transfer to LAM made this possible. They can continue with CFCI as a more independent entity, while we go with the LAM. This also frees us up to start helping other children's work. We plan to continue our work in Tijuana with drug rehabilitation and helping the elderly. We would ask for your continued support and prayers for our work, which is now under the Latin America Mission. We have an account already open there and you can start sending your donations to that address.

So if you received a letter from Eduardo, this is what it is all about. If you have been supporting that orphanage (which includes the ARCA, renamed "La Gloria"), we would encourage you to continue. Emmanuel, through CFCI, has also taken over the building project for the new orphanage. Pray for them as they try out their new wings.

Please pray for us as we transition. All of this has taken a toll on us. In January we will attend LAM's 2-week orientation. We need some rest, we hope to take some classes, and spend more time with Ian and Anna. While continuing with our current responsibilities in Tijuana, we need God's help as we rethink and retool during the next few months to be able to serve better. There are some other children's ministries God has put on our hearts. There's plenty of work for everyone in God's harvest field. Please pray with us for God's guidance.

Please send contributions to:
Latin America Mission
PO Box 527900
Miami, FL 33152-7900
Tel. (800) 275-8410



Contact information:
WRITE US at: 173 Whitney St.
Chula Vista, CA 91910
CALL US: (619) 420-7270
E-MAIL: gkoff@sbcglobal.net